

EYES >

Uniquely, chameleons are able to move each eye independently of the other.

With eyes pointing in different directions, the chameleon can look out for predators while also searching for prey. Chameleons do not have ears.

**✓ SKIN COLOUR**

The striking skin colours are caused by cells called chromatophores, which contain a variety of pigments and reflectors. The cells' size and dispersion of pigments change with the chameleon's mood, often quickly and dramatically, as a signal to potential rivals and mates.



the muscular tongue and its mucus envelop the prey, pulling it to the mouth

insect prey

robust scales protrude from the snout to form a small horn

wide jaw

long tail

sharp spines run from the mouth along the underside of the chin

< TONGUE

The tongue is very long and is fired from the mouth at great speed. This means that the chameleon can seize unsuspecting prey from some distance away.

**✓ CLAWED FEET**

The chameleon's toes are clawed, and arranged in groups of two and three on opposite sides of the foot. This enables the animal to grip any branch tightly.

**TAIL >**

Life up in the trees is made a lot easier by the chameleon's prehensile tail. It acts as a fifth limb, wrapping around branches to help with climbing.

✓ UNDERSIDE

This chameleon was photographed through a glass table from below. They rarely, if ever, have to walk on flat ground; when they do, their feet are splayed.

ridge of spines

splayed foot

